

Skills Summary

Teen Numbers: Tens and Ones

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Making a number from tens and ones

Rule: 1 ten is worth 10. To make the number, start at 10 and count on the ones. The tens digit is always written first.

Example: What number is 1 ten and 7 ones?

Step 1. We know the tens and the ones — start at the value of the ten, then count on the ones.

Step 2. 1 ten is 10. Count on 7 ones: 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17.

⇒ 1 ten and 7 ones make **17**

Try it: What number is 1 ten and 5 ones?

check: 15

Finding the tens and ones in a number

Rule: The left digit counts the tens. The right digit counts the ones. Do not swap them — the places give the digits their meaning!

Example: How many tens and ones are in 18?

Step 1. Read the number place by place — left digit for tens, right digit for ones.

Step 2. 18 is 10 and 8 more, so the 1 counts the tens and the 8 counts the ones.

⇒ 18 has **1** ten and **8** ones

Try it: How many tens and ones are in 14?

check: 1 ten, 4 ones

(!) Watch out: 3 tens and 1 one is NOT the same as 1 ten and 3 ones. Swapping the digits makes a different, much bigger or much smaller number.

Comparing numbers with swapped digits

Rule: Compare the tens first. More tens means a bigger number. Only when the tens are equal do you compare the ones.

Example: Which is more: 4 tens 1 one, or 1 ten 4 ones?

Step 1. Build both numbers first, then compare their tens.

Step 2. 4 tens 1 one is 41. 1 ten 4 ones is 14. 4 tens beats 1 ten.

⇒ **41** is more than **14**

Try it: Which is more: 3 tens 1 one, or 1 ten 3 ones?

check: 31 is more